TEACHER GUIDE DRAFT

Junior Cycle Business Studies (NCCA)

An organisation and its community



Strand 2: Enterprise
2.5, 2.4 An organisation and its community;
Strand 1 · 1.9 Ethical perspective

A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise an organisation and its community on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Closing a branch

Round 1

You close a loss-making branch. Its 10 staff lose their jobs.

Who gains and who loses?

- **A** Suppliers gain, staff lose
- **B** Staff gain, owners lose
- **C** Customers gain, owners lose
- **D** Owners gain, staff lose

ANSWER

✓ Owners gain, staff lose

Why: Cutting a loss raises owners' profit, but the staff lose their income.

2 Who would object

Round 1

You plan to build a bigger showroom on part of a local park.

Which two groups are most likely to object?

- **A** A local environmental group
- **B** Your shareholders
- **C** Your car suppliers
- **D** Your sales staff
- **E** Local residents

ANSWER

✓ A local environmental group
✓ Local residents

Why: Residents and pressure groups lose the park; the firm's own groups gain.

3 Rank fair wage cost

Round 2

Three branches move staff to a fairer wage.

Order by extra cost a week, lowest first?

- **A** 15 staff, €20 more each
- **B** 6 staff, €80 more each
- **C** 10 staff, €40 more each

ANSWER

1. 15 staff, €20 more each
2. 10 staff, €40 more each
3. 6 staff, €80 more each

Why: €300, €400 and €480 a week: the most staff is the lowest cost.

Topic tasks

4 Fair pay cost

Round 2

You raise pay above what rivals pay.

Extra wage cost a year? 52 weeks.

Staff	**12 staff**
Pay now, each, a week	**€470**
Rise, each, a week	**€35**

ANSWER

€21,840

12 × €35 × 52 = €21,840

Why: Fair pay costs more, but staff are more likely to stay.

5 Green or cheaper

Round 3

A green valeting firm costs €300 more a month. Most buyers say the planet matters to them.

Which firm should you use, and why?

A Your current, cheaper firm

B The green valeting firm

ANSWER

✓ The green valeting firm

Why: Your buyers value it, so the green choice can win sales and goodwill worth more than €300.

6 Above-minimum pay

Round 3

You pay staff well above the legal minimum wage, though rivals do not.

Which pair of effects is most likely?

A Higher wage costs, lower turnover

B Lower wage costs, higher turnover

C Lower wage costs, lower turnover

D Higher wage costs, higher turnover

ANSWER

✓ Higher wage costs, lower turnover

Why: Fair pay costs more, but staff are more likely to stay.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions. Pick the question topic “Stakeholders, ethics and the community”: the 6 come from these 10 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Explain why owners and customers may want different things.”

1 Who is a stakeholder in a car dealership?
✔ **Anyone the business affects: staff, customers, neighbours**

2 A dealer plans late-night deliveries that will wake nearby residents. Whose interests conflict?
✔ **The owners’ and the local community’s**

3 A dealer could sell a car with a hidden fault for full price. Why is honesty the better business decision?
✔ **Trust brings repeat customers and protects the firm’s name**

4 What does it mean for a business to act ethically?
✔ **Doing what is right and fair, not just what is legal**

5 How can a dealership have a positive economic impact on its community?
✔ **By creating local jobs and buying from local firms**

6 A dealership switches to recycling waste oil and LED lighting. Which type of impact on the community is this?
✔ **Environmental**

7 Shareholders want a bigger dividend and staff want a pay rise, but both cannot happen this year. What should a responsible owner do?
✔ **Weigh both groups’ interests and explain the decision openly**

8 Which is a social impact of a dealership on its community?
✔ **Sponsoring the local GAA club**

9 A customer, a technician and a bank that lent money: which of them are stakeholders?
✔ **All three**

10 A dealer donates €2,000 to a local charity and advertises the donation widely. Which view is a fair criticism?
✔ **The motive may be publicity rather than community**